Samantha Register

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Visiting Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science, Colorado State University. 2026-present.

EDUCATION

PhD, Department of Political Science, University of Colorado Boulder. 2020-2026.

Concentrations: American Politics, Political Methodology
Dissertation: Not Me, Us: Exploring Political Parasocial Relationships in the Digital Age

MA, Political Science, University of Colorado Boulder. 2022.

MA, Political Science, University of Colorado Denver. 2019.

BA, English Literature, University of California, Irvine. 2012.

PUBLICATIONS

Register, Samantha. (2026). "Who's Engaging in Political Discussions on Social Media? Comparing the Effects of Self-Monitoring and Moral Certainty." *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications.*

Register, Samantha, Parinandi, Srinivas, and Alexandra A. Siegel. (2026). "Who Claims Fraud? Correlates of State Legislators' Voter Fraud Claims." *Legislative Studies Quarterly*, 51(3), e70069.

Register, Samantha. (2025). "Red, Blue, and Going for Gold: Partisan Support for Olympic Host Bids." *Urban Affairs Review*, 61(2), 348-374.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Substantive: American Political Behavior, Campaigns and Elections, Political Communication, State and Urban Politics

Methodological: Survey Design and Analysis, Text as Data

WORKING PAPERS

"'I Am Once Again Asking You': The Connection Between Parasocial Bonds, Campaign Communications, and Participation" (Revise & Resubmit)

"Family Ties on Social Media: Updating Richard Fenno's 'Home Style' for the Digital Age" (Under Review)

"Better Understanding the Political Dynamics of the God Gap" (with Janet M. Box-Steffensmeier, Anand Sokhey, and Natalie Thacher)

"Pantsuits and Pearls: Exploring News Coverage of Candidate Appearance and Gender"

"Public Opinion on Age and Holding Federal Office" (with Anand Sokhey, Katie Glenn, and Stone Neilon)

"The Partisan Dynamics of Electoral College Support" (with Anand Sokhey and Katie Glenn)

"Throwing out Bums, Bunglers, and Bandits: Recall Elections in Local Politics" (with Kenneth Bickers and Lapo Salucci)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Colorado State University (Undergraduate):

POLS 101: American Government and Politics. Fall 2026, Spring 2027.

POLS 306: Executive Politics. Fall 2026, Spring 2027.

POLS 320: Empirical Political Analysis. Spring 2027.

POLS 409: Urban and Regional Politics. Fall 2026.

University of Colorado Boulder (Undergraduate):

PSCI 1101: Introduction to American Politics (online asynchronous). Summer 2026.

PSCI 3075: Applied Political Science Research. Spring 2026.

PSCI 3155: Survey Design and Analysis. Fall 2025.

PSCI 3021: U.S. Campaigns and Elections (online asynchronous). Summer 2024.

PSCI 3011: The American Presidency and the Executive Branch. Fall 2023.

PSCI 1101: Introduction to American Politics (Teaching Assistant). Fall 2020, Spring 2021, Spring 2022.

PSCI 2075: Quantitative Research Methods (Teaching Assistant). Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Spring 2025.

Methods Lab Coordinator. Fall 2024.

University of Colorado Denver (Undergraduate):

Introduction to American Politics (Teaching Assistant). Fall 2019.

Women's Rights, A Global Perspective (Teaching Assistant). Fall 2018.

Teaching Certification and Additional Experience

Graduate Part-Time Instructor Excellence Award. Spring 2026.

Online Teaching Micro-Credential. University of Colorado School of Continuing Education. Spring 2025.

Certificate in College Teaching. University of Colorado Center for Teaching and Learning. Spring 2024.

Additional teaching interests: Political Psychology, State Government and Politics, Text as Data

FUNDING AND RESEARCH AWARDS

Philosophy, Politics, and Economics Student Grant. University of Colorado. 2026.

Summer Dissertation Completion Fellowship. University of Colorado Graduate School. 2025.

Collegiality and Scholarship Excellence Award. CU Graduate and Professional Student Government. 2025.

McLauren Futures Family Fellowship. University of Colorado Graduate School. 2025.

Gambill Graduate Student Award. University of Colorado. 2025.

Graduate Student Award. Center to Advance Research and Teaching in the Social Sciences. 2024.

Graduate Research Grant. CU Department of Political Science. 2024.

Graduate Student Award. Center to Advance Research and Teaching in the Social Sciences. 2023.

SOFTWARE PROFICIENCY

`RStudio`, LaTeX, Qualtrics

RECENT CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

"'I am once again asking you': The Connection Between Parasocial Bonds, Campaign Communications, and Participation." Southern Political Science Association Summer Conference. June 2026.

"The Politics of Sports, Megaevents, and Urban Spaces." APSA Teaching Learning Symposium on Teaching Sports and Politics. June 2026.

"Look What She Made You Do? Examining the Impact of Parasocial Bonds with Celebrities on Political Behavior." American Political Science Association, Vancouver, BC. September 2025.

"Public Opinion on Age and Holding Federal Office" (with Anand Sokhey, Katie Glenn, and Stone Neilon). Front Range Political Science Association, Denver, CO. May 2025.

"Political Parasocial Relationships: Updating Richard Fenno's Home Style for the Digital Age." Women in Legislative Studies Virtual Meeting. April 2025.

"Not Me, Us: Political Parasocial Relationships in the Digital Age." Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL. April 2025.

"Home Style 2.0: Political Parasocial Relationships in the Digital Age." American Political Science Association, Philadelphia, PA. September 2024.

"Does Potential for Public Spending Decrease Support for Olympic Host Bids?" Southern Political Science Association, New Orleans, LA. January 2024.

"Who Claims Fraud? State Legislators' Voter Fraud Claims in the 2020 Election" (with Srinivas Parinandi and Alexandra Siegel). American Political Science Association, Los Angeles, CA. August 2023.

"Insecure Majorities on Social Media." Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL. April 2023.

"Who's Engaging in Political Discussions on Social Media? Comparing the Effects of Self-Monitoring and Moral Certainty." Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL. April 2022.

MEDIA APPEARANCES AND PUBLIC OUTREACH

"Colorado Political Climate Survey 2024 Report." American Politics Research Lab Survey, University of Colorado Boulder, November 2024.

"A Public Affair Election Panel." KGNU Community Radio, August 2024.

"Study looks into politics behind hosting the Olympics." *9News Denver*, July 2024.

SERVICE

Research Mentor to Undergraduate Students, CU Institute of Behavioral Science. 2024-2026.

Reviewer, *Public Opinion Quarterly.* 2026.

Reviewer, *Legislative Studies Quarterly.* 2025.

Reviewer, *Urban Affairs Review.* 2025.

Graduate Teaching Program Lead, CU Center for Teaching and Learning. 2024-2025.

President, Graduate Students in Political Science, University of Colorado Boulder. 2024-2025.

Advisory Committee, Institute of Behavioral Science Studio Lab. 2024.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP

Member: American Political Science Association, Midwest Political Science Association, Southern Political Science Association

REFERENCES

Dr. Anand Sohkey
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